

Graphics

Using Images in Confluence

You can also reach out to the Technical Documentation team internally.

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Why use images?

In short, images make learning easier. Images provide additional context to an idea, or act as a visual example. They also help to break up sections of text, and give our brains a break from processing large blocks of words.

Wait for it ... a picture is worth a thousand words.

In some instances, images are not optional. This is especially the case when we're talking about game art or imagery. For the sake of clarification alone, include the image.

When to use images

Consider the complexity of the topic or process you're explaining. If it involves intricate steps or visual elements, include images to make it easier for readers to follow.

It's a good idea to include both text and visuals to create a well-rounded and engaging reader experience. Your content doesn't have to be gorgeous, but it should be informative and interesting enough to keep the reader engaged. Images help with this.

Choose simple, clear images

Choose simple and clear images for illustrating your point. Avoid unnecessary complexity. Trim any part of the image that isn't needed.

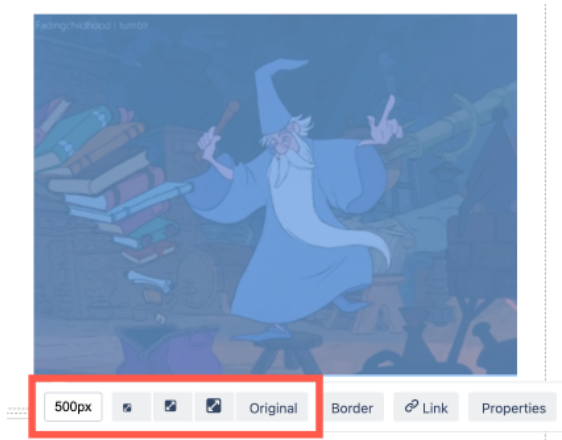
Don't hesitate to fully capture your subject, but make it easy for the user to understand and see what you need them to.

Go big on resolution and use image sizing

It's best to attach high resolution images to the page, and then resize them using Confluence's native resizing option. This way, when a reader clicks on the image, they can see the full detail of the original.

How to select an image display size:

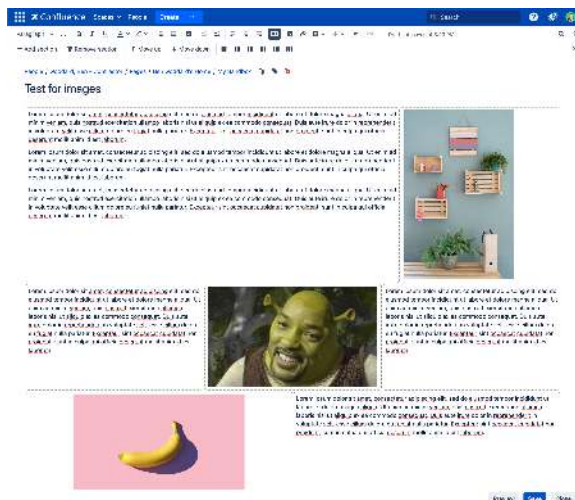
1. While editing a page, attach the full resolution image to the page.
2. Click the image to select it. The image options menu appears below the image.
3. Choose a predefined size by clicking the **small**, **medium**, or **large** resize buttons under the image
Or
4. Enter a width in pixels. (It's best to be consistent and use the same size for similar images.)



The original full-resolution image is stored with the page, and is shown when the user clicks the image.

Layout and placement

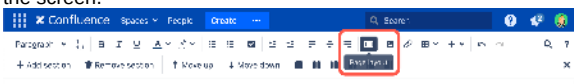
By default, Confluence places images in-line with text. If you want to place images to the side of text, it's best to use **sections**.



Sections are invisible, responsive blocks that are used to arrange content on the page. Sections can contain anything that you'd normally include on a page, including text, images, macros, tables, and so forth.

How to add a section to a page:

1. While editing a page, click the **Page Layout** button at the top of the screen.



2. Click the **Add section** button to add a blank section to the page.

After placing a section on the page, you can place content inside of it, move it up or down the page, and change the column layout.

- Click inside a section to add or edit content.
- Use the **Move up** and **Move down** buttons to rearrange the section up or down on the page.
- Click the **section columns** buttons to adjust the number and width of columns in the current section.



- Click the **Remove section** button to delete the current section and all the content inside of it.

Always attach images to the page

Due to how Confluence stores images, if you paste an image onto a page, it might not be there in the future. **Confluence has been known to break images that are simply pasted onto a page** and are not manually uploaded and attached.



Important

It's critical that we use Confluence's upload feature to attach images to a page.

If you have an image stored elsewhere, save the image locally and attach it to the page. The default size limit for images in Confluence is 100mb per image.

You may attach images to a page in a few ways. Use whichever is easiest for you.

Attach images while editing a page

This is likely the most common method, as we tend to be in the middle of writing when we realize we need an image.

How to attach images while editing a page:

1. While editing a page, place your cursor where you want the image to be.
2. At the top of the page, click **Insert files and images**.



3. Upload the image file(s). (Confluence stores them with the page metadata.)
4. Click **Insert** to place the image.

Attach images while viewing a page

Attaching files or images can be done while simply viewing a page, as well. If you have a collection of images that you know you will be using on the page, you can upload and attach them in advance of needing them.

How to attach images while viewing a page:

1. In the upper-right of the page, click the three dot menu (⋮).
2. Select **Attachments**.
3. Do one of the following:
 - a. Upload a single file by clicking **Choose File**. Add an optional comment to the file. Click **Attach**.
 - b. Click **Attach more files** to add multiple files, with optional comments. Click **Attach** for each file.
 - c. Upload multiple files at once by dragging files from your system onto the **"Drop files here to attach"** dropdown.

Tip: Press T while viewing a page to access the attachments screen.

Styling images

Use captions to describe images

While images often assist the text, sometimes a caption helps clarify an image. Captions can be added manually.

How to add a caption to an image:

1. Move the cursor to the right of the image.
2. Press **Shift+Enter** (**Shift+Return** on Mac) to add a soft line break.
3. Manually enter a caption below the image.

Consider adding image titles and alt text

For accessibility, it's great to have alt text and title for your images. Remember, while you may not have a visual impairment, chances are that someone going through your content can benefit from the additional information.

How to add a title or alt text to an image:

1. Click the image and select **Properties**.
2. On the left of the Image Properties window, select **Title**.
3. Enter a title and alt text for the image, then click **Save**.

Use borders for images with whitespace

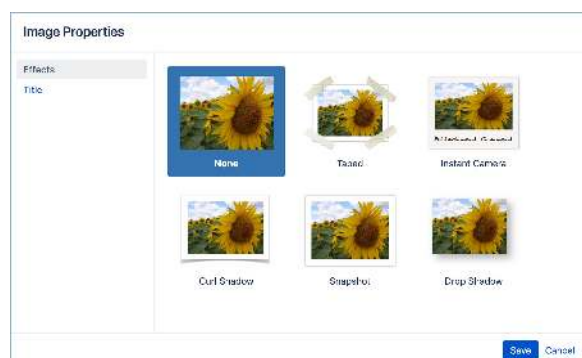
If it's hard to tell where text ends and the image begins, use Confluence's border effect to help visually distinguish the image from the background.

How to add a border to an image:

1. Click the image.
2. Select **Border**.

Avoid image effects

Simple is better. Avoid styling images with Confluence's built in Effects.



These “fun” built-in Confluence effects get old quickly.

Avoid animated GIFs

Animated GIFs tend to be resource hogs. They can also bog down a page load, or even stop the page from loading. And we want people to read our stuff!

If you're illustrating a specific function and use a short animated GIF, this is fine. For anything other than the smallest bits of animation, consider **embedding a video instead**.

Icons can help

In lieu of describing a button with text, you can add very small images to a page to act as icons. This can be useful for including icon or button references inside of text, like this:

[Example Step]

- In Google Docs, the **highlight button** helps you style your text.

If you use these sorts of “image icons,” be consistent in size.

Emojis

Feel free to use emojis on the page to make a point or add a miniature

splash of joy. 🍷🍷

To bring up the emojis palette, use the correct keyboard shortcut for your OS:

- **Windows:** Press **Windows logo key + Period**.
- **Mac:** Press **Control + Command + Space**.

Remember, emojis look different on different OS and devices. For more information on how emojis are styled across platforms, check out [Emojiipedia](#).

iOS / macOS	Twitter	Facebook	Windows
			

Screenshots, how d’ya do?

Screenshots are images, and should be attached to a Confluence page like all other images. However, here's some guidance on how to use screenshots in your content.

Make them clear

You can use any tool you like to take screenshots. Here are some of the built-in OS screenshot methods:

- **Windows:** Try the [Snipping Tool](#) (**Windows logo key + Shift + S**) to take a screenshot.
- **Mac:** Press **Command + Shift + 4** to take a screenshot.

If you'd like to use a professional screenshot tool, we recommend [Snagit](#); it's the industry standard.

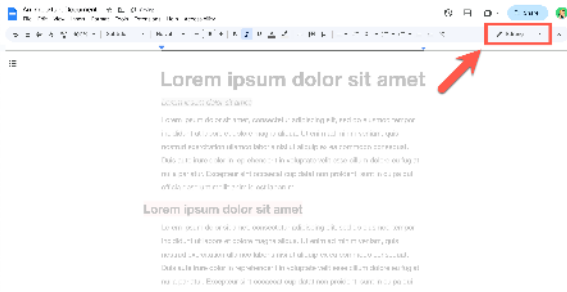
Add Pointers, Highlights, and Outlines for Emphasis

It's a good idea to show context if possible. For example, if you're describing the location of something in a larger window, consider capturing the entire window, then draw attention to the location of the relevant portion with a box or an arrow.

We recommend red, but any color that draws the eye can work.

Using boxes, circles, and/or arrows in your screenshot helps users locate the thing you're talking about when they compare your screenshot to their own experience.

[Example screenshot]

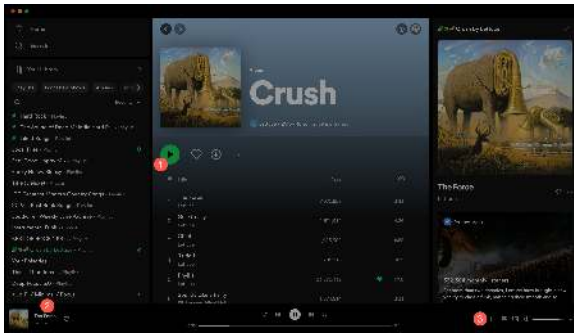


Here's an example screenshot with a box around the Editing drop-down, and an arrow pointing to the box. Extra clarity.

Numbered steps and screenshots

If you're using a screenshot that contains a few actions you'd like the user to follow in sequence, use numbers on your screenshot. Tools like Snagit make this a snap.

Here are some numbered items in the Spotify UI, as an example:

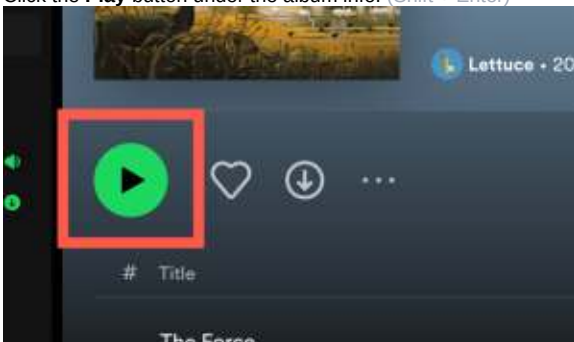


Mini screenshots in numbered steps

If you've got lots of steps, or if your screens change frequently as the user is following the steps, you can **use mini-screenshots for each step**, like this:

To view artist information in Spotify [Example]:

1. Click the **Play** button under the album info. (Shift + Enter)



2. Click the **title of the track** in the lower-left. (Shift + Enter)



3. Click the **Now Playing View** button in the lower-right. (Shift + Enter)



Note how even though we're using mini-screenshots, we have still given some visual context as to where the user is clicking.

Depending on the size of the "instructional images," you can choose to align them with the numbered steps.

To align images with instructional steps:

1. Move the cursor to the end of the step.
2. Press **Shift + Enter** (**Shift + Return** on Mac) to insert a soft line break.
3. Place your image.



Important

If you have many steps, it could be overkill to include images with each one. Consider which steps need a visual reference the most, and go with your best judgment.